In this section, you'll learn how to use the AWS CLI to upload data to and download data from S3. This approach isn't limited to offsite backups; you can use it in many other scenarios as well, such as the following:

- Sharing files with your coworkers or partners, especially when working from different locations
- Storing and retrieving artifacts needed to provision your virtual machines (such as application binaries, libraries, or configuration files)
- Outsourcing storage capacity to lighten the burden on local storage systems —in particular, for data that is accessed infrequently

First, you need to create a bucket for your data on S3. As we mentioned earlier, the name of the bucket must be unique among all other S3 buckets, even those in other regions and those of other AWS customers. To find a unique bucket name, it's useful to use a prefix or suffix that includes your company's name or your own name. Run the following command in the terminal, replacing `$yourname` with your name:

```
$ aws s3 mb s3://awsinaction-$yourname
```

Your command should look similar to this one:

```
$ aws s3 mb s3://awsinaction-awittig
```

In the unlikely event that you or another AWS customer has already created a bucket with this name, you will see the following error:

```
[... ] An error occurred (BucketAlreadyExists) [...]
```

In this case, you'll need to use a different value for `$yourname`.

Everything is ready for you to upload your data. Choose a folder you'd like to back up, such as your Desktop folder. Try to choose a folder with a total size less than 1 GB, to avoid long waiting times and exceeding the Free Tier. The following command uploads the data from your local folder to your S3 bucket. Replace `$path` with the path to your folder and `$yourname` with your name. `sync`